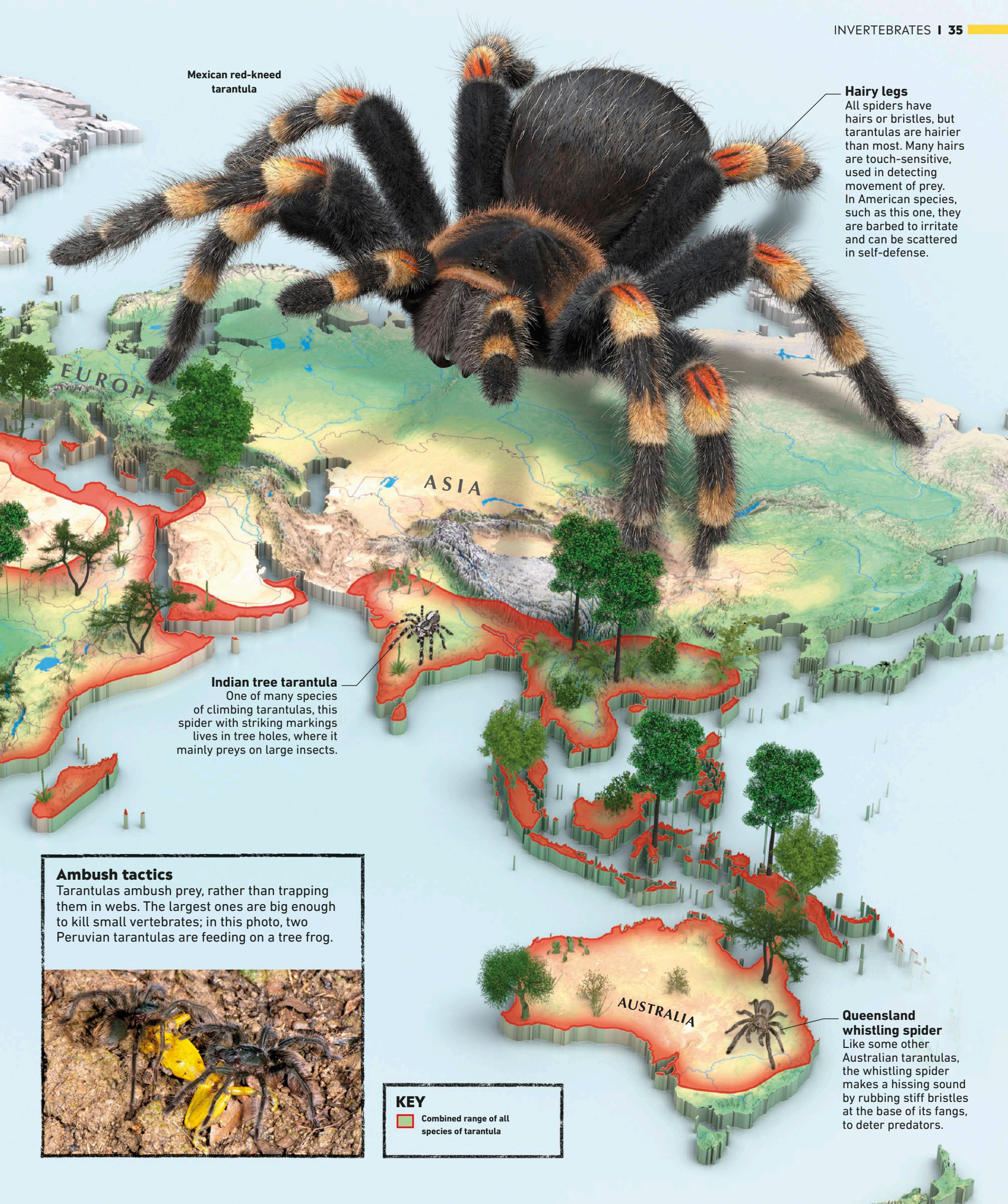


Mexican red-kneed tarantula

**Hairy legs**

All spiders have hairs or bristles, but tarantulas are hairier than most. Many hairs are touch-sensitive, used in detecting movement of prey. In American species, such as this one, they are barbed to irritate and can be scattered in self-defense.



Indian tree tarantula

One of many species of climbing tarantulas, this spider with striking markings lives in tree holes, where it mainly preys on large insects.

**Ambush tactics**

Tarantulas ambush prey, rather than trapping them in webs. The largest ones are big enough to kill small vertebrates; in this photo, two Peruvian tarantulas are feeding on a tree frog.



**KEY**

Combined range of all species of tarantula

Queensland whistling spider

Like some other Australian tarantulas, the whistling spider makes a hissing sound by rubbing stiff bristles at the base of its fangs, to deter predators.